



GenAI Adoption, Challenges & Anti-Patterns

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ABOUT M&T BANK

A community bank with the scale to deliver

Built around deep relationships, disciplined growth and lasting community impact.

\$216.5B

average total assets

Q2 2026

\$141.4B

average loans

Q2 2026

\$163.5B

average deposits

Q2 2026

**A community bank at heart.
A technology organization building what's next.**

Relationships • Communities • Disciplined long-term growth



COMMUNITY. SCALE. IMPACT.

M&T Bank

About me

- Current:

- SVP, Head of Developer Experience, M&T Bank

- Past:

- Fidelity Investments
- Capital One

- Background:

- Developer, DevOps Enthusiast, Open Source Contributor, Author
- PhD in Semiconductor Physics

Agenda

- GenAI Adoption at M&T Bank
- Challenges & Anti-Patterns across the industry

GenAI Adoption at M&T Tech

- Wide adoption for General Productivity
- GenAI adoption by Technologists
 - Coding, Code Analysis, Platform Engineering, Testing
 - Cloud Migration, Modernization
 - Vulnerability Management

GenAI Adoption Observations at M&T Tech

Aligned with industry observation

- 80/20 Rule: 80% of credits/tokens consumed by 20% of engineers
- Efficiency Increase: Days vs Weeks or Months
- Innovation: Undertaking of work that would have been put on the side
- Governance and Risk at the forefront

Challenges & Anti-Patterns: My Observations

Challenge: 100x throughput, 1x supply line

Human scale production to Machine scale production with Human in the loop

- Will today's SDLC tooling survive agent-scale coding?
- Will enterprise processes survive 100x surge
- Are customers ready to consume 100x changes

Challenge: Productivity Measurement

Output vs Outcome; Production vs Productivity

- What are enterprises getting out of GenAI?
- How do we justify GenAI Cost?
- What can we measure

Challenge: Governance

Agents can convert governance weakness into execution speed

- What are the use cases
- Reuse and Duplication
- What risks are we exposing
- What are the controls

Challenge: Context is becoming executable system

Boundary of the System has expanded

- Documentation, code comments, skills
- Conflicting requirements, specifications
- From human instructions to system executions
- Predictability

Anti Pattern: Premature Standardization

Are we at a point where standardization is meaningful?

- Skills
- Specs
- Prompt Libraries
- In-house agentic SDLC flow

Anti Pattern: Speed of Code != Speed of delivery

Distance from zero to demo collapsed. Distance from demo to product remains

- Demos everywhere
- Where do we ship it
- Who supports it
- Who funds it
- Do customers need it

Anti Pattern: Token Saving Tools

Do they actually save tokens?

- “Compressing” input and output
- Filtering input and output
- Correctness vs Token Savings
- Save turns – if you can

Final Thoughts

- Strong engineers are not replaced
- Junior engineers with agents do not suddenly become senior
- Coding, prompting, context curation, and choosing constraints are arts
- Human oversight should focus on intent, architecture, and correctness
- AI makes managers and leaders capable of directly experimenting and building again

The agent made me faster at the things I already understood. It did not grant me expertise in the things I did not know to question.

A novice asks

“Can you make this work?”

An experienced engineer asks

“What assumptions are you making, what behavior did you preserve, what could fail, what evidence supports the change, and how will we operate it?”

What I need help with

- What are your governing principles?
- How are you managing cost?
- How are you capturing Productivity measures?